Survey to the Authorities on IMF Advice on Fiscal Policy (FP) During 2021-23

Your responses are completely confidential and will remain anonymous. Results will be aggregated and not attributed to specific countries, institutions, or respondents to the survey.

The survey covers the period 2021-23.

* 1. Select your country

Type to filter

2. Please indicate the institution you work for.
(optional)

- ○ The Ministry of Finance or Treasury
- ○ The Central Bank
- ○ The Tax or Revenue Authority (if different from Ministry of Finance)
- ○ Other (please specify)

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3. Please indicate the relative importance of the following fiscal policy issues in your country/economy during 2021–2023.

	Not important	Somewhat important	Very important	Cannot assess
* Fiscal sustainability (medium-term advice)	○	○	○	○
* Output stability (short-term advice)	○	○	○	○
* Mix between fiscal and monetary policy	○	○	○	○
* Mix between fiscal and financial policy (e.g. sovereign-banking loop)	○	○	○	○
* Mix between fiscal and structural policy (e.g. support to green transition)	○	○	○	○
* Mix between fiscal and exchange rate policy	○	○	○	○
* Fiscal risks	○	○	○	○
* Financing constraints	○	○	○	○
* Development needs	○	○	○	○

4. Please indicate the relative importance of the following fiscal policy issues in the discussions with IMF staff during 2021–2023.

	Not important	Somewhat important	Very important	Cannot assess
* Fiscal sustainability (medium-term advice)	○	○	○	○
* Output stability (short-term advice)	○	○	○	○
* Mix between fiscal and monetary policy	○	○	○	○
* Mix between fiscal and financial policy (e.g. sovereign-banking loop)	○	○	○	○
* Mix between fiscal and structural policy (e.g. support to green transition)	○	○	○	○
* Mix between fiscal and exchange rate policy	○	○	○	○
* Fiscal risks	○	○	○	○
* Financing constraints	○	○	○	○
* Development needs	○	○	○	○

* 5. Please indicate your level of agreement with the following statements:

When the Fund provided fiscal policy advice in your country in the context of an Article IV consultations and/or programs...

	Disagree	Neither agree nor disagree	Agree	Cannot assess
* Fiscal policy advice identified the key issues, trends, and risks.	○	○	○	○
* Fiscal policy advice was candid.	○	○	○	○
* Fiscal policy advice was timely.	○	○	○	○
* Fiscal policy advice took into account country authorities' perspectives.	○	○	○	○
* Fiscal policy advice was sufficiently tailored to country-specific circumstances.	○	○	○	○
* Fiscal policy advice was well integrated with advice in other policy areas (e.g., monetary policy, financial stability).	○	○	○	○
* Fiscal policy advice considered tradeoffs between first-best and second-best approaches.	○	○	○	○
* IMF staff explained the rationale behind their fiscal policy advice.	○	○	○	○
* Fiscal policy advice took into account political economy constraints.	○	○	○	○
* Fiscal policy advice took into account administrative and other capacity constraints.	○	○	○	○
* Fiscal policy advice was consistent with advice to other similar countries and presented in a fair and balanced way.	○	○	○	○
* Fiscal policy advice promoted conditions that, under realistic assumptions, would support longer-term economic sustainability.	○	○	○	○

* 6. Please indicate your level of agreement with the following statements:

The Fund multilateral fiscal policy advice, for example in its flagship reports like the World Economic Outlook and the Fiscal Monitor:

	Disagree	Neither agree nor disagree	Agree	Cannot assess
* Identified the key issues, trends, and risks relevant for your country.	○	○	○	○
* Was consistent with bilateral fiscal policy advice for your country.	○	○	○	○

7. To what extent did the Fund provide adequate follow-up support for major fiscal policy decisions (e.g., through technical assistance)? Please indicate the option that best reflects your views.

- ◯ Fund support was instrumental for implementation
- ◯ Fund practical assistance was helpful at the margin
- ◯ Fund support had no influence on implementation
- ◯ Fund support for implementation turned out to be unhelpful or counterproductive (e.g., insufficient understanding of operational realities)
- ◯ Given the country's own technical capacity, no follow-up support was requested or received
- ◯ No major decisions were implemented during this period
- ◯ Cannot assess

Short-term advice

* 8. In the IMF recommendations on direction, size, and pace of fiscal policy measures, what factors were taken into account?
Select all that apply.

- [ ] Financing constraints
- [ ] Market access and fiscal sustainability
- [ ] External sustainability
- [ ] Initial cyclical conditions
- [ ] Macroeconomic impact of fiscal policy
- [ ] Cannot assess
- [ ] Other factors (for example distributional effects, borrowing costs, public investment and development needs, inward or outward spillovers,...)

9. In the IMF recommendations on composition of adjustment, which factors were taken into account?
Select all that apply.

- [ ] Initial conditions (for example, high or low level of spending or tax in relation to GDP)
- [ ] Size of the adjustment (for example, large adjustment needs may require relying on both revenue and spending measures)
- [ ] Efficiency considerations
- [ ] Distributional effects
- [ ] Effects on growth
- [ ] Long-term, e.g., age-related, spending pressures
- [ ] Advice on composition of adjustment was not provided
- [ ] Cannot assess
- [ ] Other factors: for example borrowing costs, public investment, and development needs, inward or outward spillovers (please specify)

10. If fiscal risks were discussed, what risks were discussed?
Select all that apply.

- [ ] Contingent liabilities (e.g., from state-owned enterprises or financial sector)
- [ ] Macroeconomic uncertainty
- [ ] Policy implementation risk
- [ ] Capacity implementation risk
- [ ] Debt composition and/or debt maturity
- [ ] Cannot assess
- [ ] Fiscal risks were not discussed
- [ ] Other (please specify)

* 11. Did the authorities agree with the Fund's fiscal policy advice for the short term?

- ○ Yes, always
- ○ At least 50 percent of the time
- ○ Less than 50 percent of the time
- ○ Never
- ○ Cannot assess

Follow up question if answer to Q11 is “less than 50% of the time” or “never”

11.1. Please indicate the reasons.
Select all that apply.

- [ ] Disagree with the economic rationale and/or expected impact
- [ ] Advice didn't take into account capacity constraints
- [ ] Advice didn't take into account political economy constraints
- [ ] Other (please specify)

* 12. Was the IMF staff fiscal policy advice for the short term acted upon by the authorities in your country?

- ○ Never
- ○ Less than 50% of the time
- ○ 50% of the time or more
- ○ Always
- ○ Cannot assess

Follow up question if answer to Q12 is “less than 50% of the time” or “never”

12.1. What accounts for this lack of responsiveness by the authorities?
Select all that apply.

- [ ] Fund "leverage" outside of program relationships is too limited
- [ ] Political realities didn't allow for implementation
- [ ] Fund advice wasn't time sensitive (e.g., no immediate need to respond)
- [ ] Fund staff didn't have access to policymakers at the appropriate level
- [ ] The analysis provided by staff failed to convince the authorities
- [ ] The authorities' own capabilities made it difficult for staff to add value
- [ ] With hindsight, the authorities' judgment appears to have been validated
- [ ] Cannot assess
- [ ] Doesn't apply (i.e., the authorities did act on the advice)
- [ ] Other (please specify)

Medium-term advice

* 13. In your engagement with the IMF, did staff provide an assessment of and advice on the medium-term fiscal challenges and outlook?

- ○ Yes, in detail
- ○ Partially
- ○ No
- ○ Cannot assess

Follow up question when answer to Q13 is “yes, in detail”, or “partially”

13.1. How well was this integrated in the short-term fiscal policy analysis and recommendations?

- ◯ Little or not at all
- ◯ Partially
- ◯ Extensively
- ◯ Cannot assess

14. Were medium-term fiscal anchors discussed?

- ◯ Little or not at all
- ◯ Partially
- ◯ Extensively
- ◯ Cannot assess

15. Did the authorities agree with the Fund’s fiscal policy advice for the medium term?

- ◯ Never
- ◯ Less than 50 percent of the time
- ◯ At least 50 percent of the time
- ◯ Yes, always
- ◯ Cannot assess

Follow up question when answer to Q15 is “less than 50%”, or “never”

15.1. Please indicate the reasons.
Select all that apply.

- [ ] Disagree with the economic rationale and/or expected impact
- [ ] Advice didn't take into account capacity constraints
- [ ] Advice didn't take into account political economy constraints
- [ ] Cannot assess
- [ ] Other (please specify)

16. Was the IMF fiscal policy advice acted upon by the authorities in your country?

- ○ Never
- ○ Less than 50% of the time
- ○ 50% of the time or more
- ○ Always
- ○ Cannot assess

Follow up question when answer to Q16 is “less than 50%”, or “never”

16.1. What were the reason(s)?

Select all that apply.

- [ ] Fund "leverage" outside of program relationships is too limited
- [ ] Political realities didn't allow for implementation
- [ ] Fund advice wasn't time sensitive (e.g., no immediate need to respond)
- [ ] Fund staff didn't have access to policymakers at the appropriate level
- [ ] The analysis provided by staff failed to convince the authorities
- [ ] The authorities' own capabilities made it difficult for staff to add value
- [ ] With hindsight, the authorities' judgment appears to have been validated
- [ ] Cannot assess
- [ ] Doesn't apply (i.e., the authorities did act on the advice)
- [ ] Other (please specify)

Capacity Development (CD)

* 17. If your country received training and/or technical assistance on fiscal policy, was it integrated with the fiscal policy advice under surveillance?

- ◯ Well integrated (e.g., CD activities provided good support to implementation of the fiscal advice)
- ◯ Partially integrated (e.g., CD activities provided some support to implementation of the fiscal advice)
- ◯ Not integrated (e.g., CD did not provide any support to implementation of the fiscal advice)
- ◯ Country did not receive CD
- ◯ Cannot assess

Fund's fiscal policy advice and climate/gender/social spending strategies

* 18. When the Fund provided fiscal policy advice in your country in the context of an Article IV Consultation or a Fund-supported program, did it discuss the following:

	Little or not at all	Partially	Extensively	Cannot assess	Not relevant
* How to protect the most vulnerable, even where there is a need for fiscal adjustment, and leave or create fiscal space for social spending, if needed?	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯
* How to create fiscal space for climate change mitigation/adaptation?	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯
* How fiscal policy can help achieve better gender outcomes?	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯
* How fiscal policy can help achieve Sustainable Development Goals--SDGs (if relevant)?	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

19. Additional Comments (optional).

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